Persist Week of March 16, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at **support@functional-bodybuilding.com**

We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.
This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday March 16, 2026
- Tuesday March 17, 2026
- Wednesday March 18, 2026
- Thursday March 19, 2026
- Friday March 20, 2026
- Saturday March 21, 2026
- Sunday March 22, 2026

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday March 16, 2026
- Tuesday March 17, 2026
- Wednesday March 18, 2026
- Thursday March 19, 2026
- Friday March 20, 2026
- Saturday March 21, 2026
- Sunday March 22, 2026

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday March 16, 2026
- Tuesday March 17, 2026
- Wednesday March 18, 2026
- Thursday March 19, 2026
- Friday March 20, 2026
- Saturday March 21, 2026

- Sunday March 22, 2026
- Pump Condition 5x
  - Monday March 16, 2026
  - Tuesday March 17, 2026
  - Wednesday March 18, 2026
  - Thursday March 19, 2026
  - Friday March 20, 2026
  - Saturday March 21, 2026
  - Sunday March 22, 2026
- Pump Condition 4x
  - Monday March 16, 2026
  - Tuesday March 17, 2026
  - Wednesday March 18, 2026
  - Thursday March 19, 2026
  - Friday March 20, 2026
  - Saturday March 21, 2026
  - Sunday March 22, 2026
- Pump Condition 3x
  - Monday March 16, 2026
  - Tuesday March 17, 2026
  - Wednesday March 18, 2026
  - Thursday March 19, 2026
  - Friday March 20, 2026
  - Saturday March 21, 2026
  - Sunday March 22, 2026
- Perform
  - Monday March 16, 2026
  - Tuesday March 17, 2026
  - Wednesday March 18, 2026
  - Thursday March 19, 2026
  - Friday March 20, 2026
  - Saturday March 21, 2026
  - Sunday March 22, 2026
- Minimalist
  - Monday March 16, 2026
  - Tuesday March 17, 2026
  - Wednesday March 18, 2026

Thursday March 19, 2026
Friday March 20, 2026
Saturday March 21, 2026
Sunday March 22, 2026

Pump Lift 5x

Monday March 16, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Silly Frog Pumps
Frog pumps seem like a silly exercise to some, but if you can push through the public discomfort, you'll be rewarded with a unique hip and glute pump. The different leg position targets different fibers of the glutes.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warm Up (8 min)
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Single DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side
Supinated Body Row; 12-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. The reps have decreased slightly from Week 4 allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

Neutral Grip Pull Up
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
As reps go down, make your Pull Ups harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging Pull Ups. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
DB Frog Pump; 20-30 reps @10X0
rest 60 sec
DB Gorilla Row; 10 reps/side @21X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set of each movement to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7 on the first working set, and then increase weight each set, building up to RPE 9-10 on your last set.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2-3 sets
Alternating DB Curls; 6-8 reps/side
rest 30 sec
Farmers Walk; 50m
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday March 17, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Simple Solution
Simplicity in training can be so powerful. The less you are thinking about weights or reps or sets, the more you can think about pure muscle pump. The simple Finisher format for today's training is an example of this. Keep it simple, but keep the pump big. Simple is strong!
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
DB Windmill Press; 5 reps/side
Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Same weight as Set 3)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Single Arm DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Drop back to same weight as Set 1)

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Flat Bench DB Fly; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
DB Full Raise; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
Cable Tricep Pushdown or Narrow Grip Tricep Push Up; 50 reps in as few sets as possible.
Loading Note:
Select a weight that is about a 15 rep max. Each time you come close to failure, take a brief rest period, then resume when you are ready until you complete all 50 reps.
*If you do not have access to a Cable Machine, Perform 50 Narrow Grip Tricep Push Ups in as few sets as possible.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday March 18, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Back Squat Low Reps
Low reps are not inherently dangerous, but people often think they are. The beginning of a training block uses higher reps to get your body used to these particular movements. Then later in a training block, we can lower the reps and push the throttle more.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side
Lateral Banded Walk; 15 steps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
4 Working Sets; rest 90-120 seconds between
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy

Working Set 1 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9+

Loading Note:

Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. The reps have decreased from Week 4, allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
B Stance Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

The B Stance Hip Thrust places more load on one leg at a time allowing for isolation on each side. The reps have decreased from Week 4, allowing for an increase in weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Alternating Suitcase KOT Forward Elevated Lunge; 6 reps/side @21X1
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Single Leg Calf Raise; 10-12 reps/side @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform the KOT (Knee Over Toe) Lunge for quality not load. This exercise is a great expression of full range of motion in the lower body. Use it to continue to improve your flexibility. Aim for close to failure with each set of calf raises.

F) Finisher (10-12 min):
2-3 sets
Single Leg Plank; 15-30 sec/side
Star Plank; 15-30 sec/side
Hollow Body Rock; 15-30 sec
rest 90 sec between sets

Loading Note:

*Minimal rest between exercises.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday March 19, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 15 Sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
10 Split Stance DB RDL/side (lightweight)
10 Hanging Oblique Raises/side
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 15 Sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Tall Kneeling Weight Plate Windmill x 6 reps/side (slow and controlled)
15m Quadruped Crawl Forward
15m Quadruped Crawl Backward

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Mobility
Shoulder Circles x 5 reps/side
Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min
Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Prayer Stretch x 2 min
Prone Y Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Shoulder Circles (or shoulder wall circles) x 5 reps/side
Passive Hang x 1 min

Friday March 20, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Reverse Barbell Curl
Building your biceps involves several muscles, not just one. The change in hand position of the Reverse Barbell Curl helps develop this muscle group in a slightly different way.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min)
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Inchworm Push Up; 6-8 reps
Ring Row Hold; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip; 5-7 reps @32X1
rest 15 sec
Neutral Grip Ring Row; 10-20 reps @20X0
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform a few dip warmup sets to determine weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Skullcrusher; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Reverse Barbell Curl; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10-12 min):
2-3 sets
DB Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Cable or Banded Face Pull; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Yoga Push Up; 30 seconds Max Reps.
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday March 21, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Hanging Leg Raise
For the finisher today, only perform the 40 leg raises if you can confidently complete 10 quality reps in one set. If you are still working on leg raises, do 40 knee raises instead. This regression will get you better results by targeting the working muscles.
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+

3 Sets
Step Through Reverse Lunge; 5 reps/side
Goblet Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
DB Cyclist Front Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Drop Lunge; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Wall Sit; 45-60 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one set of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Rower, Ring, or Physioball Hamstring Curl; 10-15 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Band Assisted Reverse Nordics; 8-12 reps @30X0
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For the Hamstring Curl variation, use whichever implement you have access to or feels the best to you. Aim for each set to be challenging and feel good on the targeted areas (hamstrings/knees).

E) Finisher (6-8 min):
Hanging Leg Raise or Hanging Knee Raise; Perform 40 reps in as few sets as possible. Each time you need to break, perform 10 Lateral Banded Walk/side.
Loading Note:
The goal of this finisher is to build strength in some of the smaller muscles around the pelvis and the lower abdominals. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps

Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday March 22, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x
Work In Lesson:

Big Ass Calendar

I bought a big ass calendar. It spans an entire wall. I did this out of a desire to look ahead, to wrap my mind around the entire foreseeable future.
It helps to take steps to control what we can. And the calendar is also dry-erase for a reason. Things change. Plans evaporate. Sudden curve balls come out of left field - when dang it, we were up at night worrying about different ones entirely.
So if something derails you from the track you were on with your fitness, that's okay. We all have injuries, family stuff, work stuff come up. The thing to pay attention to now is how you choose to react. The quicker you can erase the board and write something new in, the better. Because time will pass either way - don't waste it in the transitions.
With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday March 16, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Simple Solution
Simplicity in training can be so powerful. The less you are thinking about weights or reps or sets, the more you can think about pure muscle pump. The simple Finisher format for today's training is an example of this. Keep it simple, but keep the pump big. Simple is strong!
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
DB Windmill Press; 5 reps/side

Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Same weight as Set 3)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Single Arm DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Drop back to same weight as Set 1)

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Flat Bench DB Fly; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
DB Full Raise; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
Cable Tricep Pushdown or Narrow Grip Tricep Push ups; 50 reps in as few sets as possible.
Loading Note:
Select a weight that is about a 15 rep max. Each time you come close to failure, take a brief rest period, then resume when you are ready until you complete all 50 reps.
*If you do not have access to a Cable Machine, Perform 50 Narrow Grip Tricep Push ups in as few sets as possible.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday March 17, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Strength Balance
Changing the order of movements can be a subtle way to keep getting stronger in different ways. So the lower body superset will sometimes change which type of movement you do first. For example, performing lunges before squats does not feel the same as performing lunges after squats. Which feels more comfortable for you?
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Step Through Reverse Lunge; 5 reps/side
Goblet Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. The reps have decreased slightly from Week 4 allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Neutral Grip Pull Up
Every 75 sec x 6 sets

Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

As reps go down, make your pull-ups harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging pull ups. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
DB Cyclist Front Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Drop Lunge; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Wall Sit; 45-60 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.

Loading Note:

For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one pair of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
Hanging Leg Raise or Hanging Knee Raise; Perform 40 reps in as few sets as possible. Each time you need to break, perform 10 Lateral Banded Walk/side.

Loading Note:

The goal of this finisher is to build strength in some of the smaller muscles around the pelvis and the lower abdominals. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Wednesday March 18, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it. Or try a 30/30 Cardio workout in the Additional Resources section of the app.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shinbox Special
Shinbox Switch x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Hip ER Stretch x 1 min
Shinbox Hip IR Stretch x 1 min
Shinbox Rear Leg ER x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Heel Touch x 5 reps/side

Thursday March 19, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Reverse Barbell Curl
Building your biceps involves several muscles, not just one. The change in hand position of the Reverse Barbell Curl helps develop this muscle group in a slightly different way.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

D) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Inchworm Push up; 6-8 reps
Ring Row Hold; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9

Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps

Loading Note:

The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip; 5-7 reps @32X1
rest 15 sec
Neutral Grip Ring Row; 10-20 reps @20X0
rest 2 min and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform a few dip warmup sets to determine weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Skullcrusher; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Reverse Barbell Curl; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
DB Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Cable or Banded Face Pull; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Yoga Push Up; 30 seconds Max Reps.
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday March 20, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Back Squat Low Reps
Low reps are not inherently dangerous, but people often think they are. The beginning of a training block uses higher reps to get your body used to these particular movements. Then later in a training block, we can lower the reps and push the throttle more.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side
Lateral Banded Walk; 15 steps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
4 Working Sets; rest 90-120 sec between
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9+
Loading Note:
Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. The reps have decreased from Week 4, allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

B Stance Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The B Stance Hip Thrust places more load on one leg at a time allowing for isolation on each side. The reps have decreased from Week 4, allowing for an increase in weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Alternating Suitcase KOT Forward Elevated Lunge; 6 reps/side @21X1
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Single Leg Calf Raise; 10-12 reps/side @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform the KOT (Knee Over Toe) Lunge for quality not load. This exercise is a great expression of full range of motion in the lower body. Use it to continue to improve your flexibility. Aim for close to failure with each set of calf raises.

F) Finisher (4-8 min):
2-3 sets
Single Leg Plank; 15-30 sec/side
Star Plank; 15-30 sec/side
Hollow Body Rock; 15-30 sec
rest 90 sec between sets
Loading Note:
*Minimal rest between exercises.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday March 21, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Active Recovery Work (40 min):

30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 15 Sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
10 Split Stance DB RDL/side (lightweight)
10 Hanging Oblique Raises/side
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 15 Sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Tall Kneeling Weight Plate Windmill x 6 reps/side (slow and controlled)
15m Quadruped Crawl Forward
15m Quadruped Crawl Backward
PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Shoulder Extension
Passive Hang x 1 min
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 10 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10 reps

Sunday March 22, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Work In Lesson:

Big Ass Calendar

I bought a big ass calendar. It spans an entire wall. I did this out of a desire to look ahead, to wrap my mind around the entire foreseeable future.
It helps to take steps to control what we can. And the calendar is also dry-erase for a reason. Things change. Plans evaporate. Sudden curve balls come out of left field - when dang it, we were up at night worrying about different ones entirely.
So if something derails you from the track you were on with your fitness, that's okay. We all have injuries, family stuff, work stuff come up. The thing to pay attention to now is how you choose to react. The quicker you can erase the board and write something new in, the better. Because time will pass either way - don't waste it in the transitions.
With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday March 16, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: DB Positioning
Every time you change your dumbbell position for a squat or hinge, you impact the muscles that support the pelvis. Notice how these small position changes feel in your hips as you naturally brace to support each movement.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warm Up (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Single DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side
Supinated Body Row; 12-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. The reps have decreased slightly from Week 4 allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Same weight as Set 3)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
DB Cyclist Front Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Drop Lunge; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Wall Sit; 45-60 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one pair of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

F) Finisher (4-8 min):
2-3 sets
Single Leg Plank; 15-30 sec/side
Star Plank; 15-30 sec/side
Hollow Body Rock; 15-30 sec
rest 90 sec between sets
Loading Note:
*Minimal rest between exercises.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday March 17, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Shinbox Special
Shinbox Switch x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Hip ER Stretch x 1 min
Shinbox Hip IR Stretch x 1 min
Shinbox Rear Leg ER x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Heel Touch x 5 reps/side

Wednesday March 18, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Reverse Barbell Curl
Building your biceps involves several muscles, not just one. The change in hand position of the Reverse Barbell Curl helps develop this muscle group in a slightly different way.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Inchworm Push up; 6-8 reps
Ring Row Hold; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

B Stance Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The B Stance Hip Thrust places more load on one leg at a time allowing for isolation on each side. The reps have decreased from Week 4, allowing for an increase in weight.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Skullcrusher; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Reverse Barbell Curl; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
DB Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Cable or Banded Face Pull; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Yoga Push Up; 30 seconds Max Reps.
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
2) Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec
3) Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday March 19, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Shoulder Extension
Passive Hang x 1 min
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 10 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10 reps

Friday March 20, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Back Squat Low Reps
Low reps are not inherently dangerous, but people often think they are. The beginning of a training block uses higher reps to get your body used to these particular movements. Then later in a training block, we can lower the reps and push the throttle more.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side
Lateral Banded Walk; 15 steps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
4 Working Sets; rest 90-120 sec
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9+

Loading Note:
Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. The reps have decreased from Week 4, allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Neutral Grip pull up
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
As reps go down, make your pull-ups harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging pull ups. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip; 5-7 reps @32X1
rest 15 sec
Neutral Grip Ring Row; 10-20 reps @20X0
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform a few dip warmup sets to determine weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
Hanging Leg Raise or Hanging Knee Raise; Perform 40 reps in as few sets as possible. Each time you need to break, perform 10 Lateral Banded Walk/side.
Loading Note:
The goal of this finisher is to build strength in some of the smaller muscles around the pelvis and the lower abdominals. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 10 reps

Saturday March 21, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 15 Sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
10 Split Stance DB RDL/side (lightweight)
10 Hanging Oblique Raises/side
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 15 Sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
Tall Kneeling Weight Plate Windmill x 6 reps/side (slow and controlled)
15m Quadruped Crawl Forward
15m Quadruped Crawl Backward

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Upper Body Mobility
Shoulder Circles x 10 reps/direction
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side
Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side
Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec hold
Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec hold
Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec hold
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Downdog to Updog x 5 reps

Sunday March 22, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

Big Ass Calendar

I bought a big ass calendar. It spans an entire wall. I did this out of a desire to look ahead, to wrap my mind around the entire foreseeable future.
It helps to take steps to control what we can. And the calendar is also dry-erase for a reason. Things change. Plans evaporate. Sudden curve balls come out of left field - when dang it, we were up at night worrying about different ones entirely.
So if something derails you from the track you were on with your fitness, that's okay. We all have injuries, family stuff, work stuff come up. The thing to pay attention to now is how you choose to react. The quicker you can erase the board and write something new in, the better. Because time will pass either way - don't waste it in the transitions.
With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday March 16, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Silly Frog Pumps
Frog pumps seem like a silly exercise to some, but if you can push through the public discomfort, you'll be rewarded with a unique hip and glute pump. The different leg position targets different fibers of the glutes.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Single DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side
Supinated Body Row; 12-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. The reps have decreased slightly from Week 4 allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
DB Frog Pump; 20-30 reps @10X0
rest 30-60 sec
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 8-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set of each movement to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7 on the first working set, and then increase weight each set, building up to RPE 9-10 on your last set.

E) Pull and Core Conditioning (12-15 min):
2 Sets
For Time
500/400m Row @ 85% effort (male/female)
-60sec rest-
4 rounds for time:
12 Alternating KB Plank Row
40 Double Unders or 60 Single Unders
-60-second rest and then repeat from the beginning for a second set-
Effort Note:
Perform the first set at a sustainable pace. The second set should be close to consistent speed as the first set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday March 17, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Simple Solution
Simplicity in training can be so powerful. The less you are thinking about weights or reps or sets, the more you can think about pure muscle pump. The simple Conditioning format for today's training is an example of this. Keep it simple, but keep the pump big. Simple is strong!
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
DB Windmill Press; 5 reps/side
Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Same weight as Set 3)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Flat Bench DB Fly; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
DB Full Raise; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
15-12-10-8-6
Alternating DB Glute Bridge Floor Press
DB Burpee

rest 30 sec between sets
Effort Note:
Select a weight that you can perform for multiple sets of 15 reps. Use the same weight for Floor Press and Burpees.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday March 18, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Back Squat Low Reps
Low reps are not inherently dangerous, but people often think they are. The beginning of a training block uses higher reps to get your body used to these particular movements. Then later in a training block, we can lower the reps and push the throttle more.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side
Lateral Banded Walk; 15 steps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
4 Working Sets; rest 90-120 seconds between sets
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9+
Loading Note:

Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. The reps have decreased from Week 4, allowing for an increase in weight.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
B Stance Barbell Hip Thrust; 5 reps/side
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Single Leg Calf Raise; 10-12 reps/side @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
10 Left Leg Goblet Step Up 70/50# (male/female)
10 Right Leg Goblet Step Up 70/50#
15-20 Cal Bike
rest 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
The suggested loads are only here as a reference point. I want you to be able to move smoothly through all your weight reps without having to take breaks or slow down. If that means you need to lighten up your weight, then please do so.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday March 19, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 15 Sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality

10 Split Stance DB RDL/side (lightweight)
10 Hanging Oblique Raises/side
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 15 Sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Tall Kneeling Weight Plate Windmill x 6 reps/side (slow and controlled)
15m Quadruped Crawl Forward
15m Quadruped Crawl Backward

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Mobility
Shoulder Circles x 5 reps/side
Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min
Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Prayer Stretch x 2 min
Prone Y Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Shoulder Circles (or shoulder wall circles) x 5 reps/side
Passive Hang x 1 min

Friday March 20, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Reverse Barbell Curl
Building your biceps involves several muscles, not just one. The change in hand position of the Reverse Barbell Curl helps develop this muscle group in a slightly different way.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps
Ring Row Hold; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps

Loading Note:

The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, on a scale of 10 where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Skullcrusher; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Reverse Barbell Curl; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from Week 1 and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories @ high effort (male/female)
8-15 Wide Grip Push-Ups Unbroken
Move immediately into the next couplet -
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories @ high effort
12-15 Body Row
Effort Note:
The goal is to have the work completed around the 1min mark, giving you 1 full minute to rest on each set. If you find your work is taking you significantly longer than 1 minute, then reduce the calories or reps on either movement.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side

Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday March 21, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Hanging Leg Raise
For the conditioning today, reduce the hanging leg raise to 8 reps, or change the movement to a hanging knee tuck for 16 reps if leg raises are too challenging. Or challenge yourself with as many leg raises as you can each set, then fill in the rest with the scaled version. We always want to first make sure the target area is being used effectively without compensations (in this case, your core and hip flexors). Then create a path to build up to the skill you want to achieve.
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Step Through Reverse Lunge; 5 reps/side
Goblet Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
DB Cyclist Front Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Drop Lunge; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Wall Sit; 45-60 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one set of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15sec
8/side DB Rack Curtsy Squat @ 20X0 50/35# or 35/20# (male/female)
16 Hanging Leg Raise or Hanging Knee Tucks

rest 15sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3-4 - Tough Pace

E) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday March 22, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Big Ass Calendar

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It helps to take steps to control what we can. And the calendar is also dry-erase for a reason. Things change. Plans evaporate. Sudden curve balls come out of left field - when dang it, we were up at night worrying about different ones entirely.
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With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday March 16, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Simple Solution

Simplicity in training can be so powerful. The less you are thinking about weights or reps or sets, the more you can think about pure muscle pump. The simple Finisher format for today's training is an example of this. Keep it simple, but keep the pump big. Simple is strong!
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
DB Windmill Press; 5 reps/side
Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Same weight as Set 3)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 4-6 reps @31X2
rest 30sec
Flat Bench DB Fly; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 30sec
DB Full Raise; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
15-12-10-8-6
Alternating DB Glute Bridge Floor Press
DB Burpee
rest 30 sec between sets
Effort Note:

Select a weight that you can perform for multiple sets of 15 reps. Use the same weight for Floor Press and Burpees.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
2) Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
3) Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday March 17, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Strength Balance
Changing the order of movements can be a subtle way to keep getting stronger in different ways. So the lower body superset will sometimes change which type of movement you do first. For example, performing lunges before squats does not feel the same as performing lunges after squats. Which feels more comfortable for you?
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Single DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side
Supinated Body Row; 12-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. The reps have decreased slightly from Week 4 allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
DB Cyclist Front Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Drop Lunge; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Wall Sit; 45-60 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one pair of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15sec
8/side DB Rack Curtsy Squat @ 20X0 50/35# or 35/20# (male/female)
16 Hanging Leg Raise or Hanging Knee Tucks
rest 15sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3-4 - Tough Pace

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Wednesday March 18, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shinbox Special
Shinbox Switch x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Hip ER Stretch x 1 min
Shinbox Hip IR Stretch x 1 min
Shinbox Rear Leg ER x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Heel Touch x 5 reps/side

Thursday March 19, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Reverse Barbell Curl
Building your biceps involves several muscles, not just one. The change in hand position of the Reverse Barbell Curl helps develop this muscle group in a slightly different way.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps
Ring Row Hold; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Skullcrusher; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Reverse Barbell Curl; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from Week 1 and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories @ high effort (male/female)
6-8 Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip @ 30X0
Move immediately into the next couplet -
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories @ high effort
12-15 Body Row
Effort Note:
The goal is to have the work completed around the 1min mark, giving you 1 full minute to rest on each set. If you find your work is taking you significantly longer than 1 minute, then reduce the calories or reps on either movement.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday March 20, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Back Squat Low Reps
Low reps are not inherently dangerous, but people often think they are. The beginning of a training block uses higher reps to get your body used to these particular movements. Then later in a training block, we can lower the reps and push the throttle more.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Step Through Reverse Lunge; 5 reps/side
Goblet Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
4 Working Sets; rest 90-120 seconds between
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9+
Loading Note:
Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. The reps have decreased from Week 4, allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
B Stance Barbell Hip Thrust; 5 reps/side
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Single Leg Calf Raise; 10-12 reps/side @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
10 Left Leg Goblet Step Up 70/50# (male/female)
10 Right Leg Goblet Step Up 70/50#
15-20 Cal Bike
rest 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:

The suggested loads are only here as a reference point. I want you to be able to move smoothly through all your weight reps without having to take breaks or slow down. If that means you need to lighten up your weight, then please do so.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday March 21, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 15 Sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
10 Split Stance DB RDL/side (light weight)
10 Hanging Oblique Raises/side
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 15 Sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Tall Kneeling Weight Plate Windmill x 6 reps/side (slow and controlled)
15m Quadruped Crawl Forward
15m Quadruped Crawl Backward

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Shoulder Extension
Passive Hang x 1 min
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 10 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10 reps

Sunday March 22, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x
Work In Lesson:

Big Ass Calendar

I bought a big ass calendar. It spans an entire wall. I did this out of a desire to look ahead, to wrap my mind around the entire foreseeable future.
It helps to take steps to control what we can. And the calendar is also dry-erase for a reason. Things change. Plans evaporate. Sudden curve balls come out of left field - when dang it, we were up at night worrying about different ones entirely.
So if something derails you from the track you were on with your fitness, that's okay. We all have injuries, family stuff, work stuff come up. The thing to pay attention to now is how you choose to react. The quicker you can erase the board and write something new in, the better. Because time will pass either way - don't waste it in the transitions.
With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday March 16, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Second Time Through
The second time through an exercise, the weight and movement pattern should feel more comfortable. This increased comfort should allow you to get even more out of it than the first time through, now that your mind and body have settled in together.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Single DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side
Supinated Body Row; 12-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. The reps have decreased slightly from Week 4 allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 4-6 reps @31X2
rest 30sec
DB Strict Press; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 30sec
DB Full Raise; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15sec
8/side DB Rack Curtsy Squat @ 20X0 50/35# or 35/20# (male/female)
16 Hanging Leg Raise Hanging Knee Tucks
rest 15sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3-4 - Tough Pace

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets

Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday March 17, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shinbox Special
Shinbox Switch x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Hip ER Stretch x 1 min
Shinbox Hip IR Stretch x 1 min
Shinbox Rear Leg ER x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Heel Touch x 5 reps/side

Wednesday March 18, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Strength Balance
Changing the order of movements can be a subtle way to keep getting stronger in different ways. So the lower body superset will sometimes change which type of movement you do first. For example, performing lunges before squats does not feel the same as performing lunges after squats. Which feels more comfortable for you?
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Inchworm Push up; 6-8 reps
Ring Row Hold; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Floor Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps

Loading Note:

The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
DB Cyclist Front Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Drop Lunge; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Wall Sit; 45-60 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.

Loading Note:

For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one pair of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories @ high effort (male/female)
6-8 Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip @ 30X0
Move immediately into the next couplet -
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories @ high effort
12-15 Body Row
Effort Note:
The goal is to have the work completed around the 1min mark, giving you 1 full minute to rest on each set. If you find your work is taking you significantly longer than 1 minute, then reduce the calories or reps on either movement.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday March 19, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Shoulder Extension
Passive Hang x 1 min
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 10 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10 reps

Friday March 20, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Back Squat Low Reps
Low reps are not inherently dangerous, but people often think they are. The beginning of a training block uses higher reps to get your body used to these particular movements. Then later in a training block, we can lower the reps and push the throttle more.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side

Lateral Banded Walk; 15 steps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
4 Working Sets; rest 90-120 seconds between
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9+
Loading Note:
Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. The reps have decreased from Week 4, allowing for an increase in weight.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Skullcrusher; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Reverse Barbell Curl; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from Week 1 and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
8 Double Pushup Burpee
16 Alternating DB Snatch (8/side) 50/35#
15-20 Cal Bike
rest 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
The suggested loads are only here as a reference point. I want you to be able to move smoothly through all your weight reps without having to take breaks or slow down. If that means you need to lighten up your weight, then please do so.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets

Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 10 reps

Saturday March 21, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 15 Sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
10 Split Stance DB RDL/side (lightweight)
10 Hanging Oblique Raises/side
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 15 Sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Tall Kneeling Weight Plate Windmill x 6 reps/side (slow and controlled)
15m Quadruped Crawl Forward
15m Quadruped Crawl Backward

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Upper Body Mobility
Shoulder Circles x 10 reps/direction
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 1 min/side
Childs Pose Reach Through x 1 min/side
Kneeling Triceps Stretch x 30 sec/side
Behind the Back Neck Stretch x 30 sec/side
Prone I x 3 reps with 5 sec hold
Prone T x 3 reps with 5 sec hold
Prone Y x 3 reps with 5 sec hold
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 3 reps
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Downdog to Updog x 5 reps

Sunday March 22, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x
Work In Lesson:

Big Ass Calendar

I bought a big ass calendar. It spans an entire wall. I did this out of a desire to look ahead, to wrap my mind around the entire foreseeable future.
It helps to take steps to control what we can. And the calendar is also dry-erase for a reason. Things change. Plans evaporate. Sudden curve balls come out of left field - when dang it, we were up at night worrying about different ones entirely.
So if something derails you from the track you were on with your fitness, that's okay. We all have injuries, family stuff, work stuff come up. The thing to pay attention to now is how you choose to react. The quicker you can erase the board and write something new in, the better. Because time will pass either way - don't waste it in the transitions.
With love,
Marcus

Perform

Monday March 16, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Silly Frog Pumps
Frog pumps seem like a silly exercise to some, but if you can push through the public discomfort, you'll be rewarded with a unique hip and glute pump. The different leg position targets different fibers of the glutes.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Single DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side
Supinated Body Row; 12-15 reps

C) HOT START (10-12 minutes):
4 Rounds Increasing Effort:
18/15 Calorie Bike (male/female)

12 Alternating KB Half Snatch (6/side) 53/35# or 35/26#
12 Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand
rest 45 sec between rounds
Effort Note:
Round 1 - Moderate
Round 2 - Hard
Round 3-4 - Very Tough Pace

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. The reps have decreased slightly from Week 4 allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
DB Frog Pump; 20-30 reps @10X0
rest 30-60 sec
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 8-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set of each movement to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7 on the first working set, and then increase weight each set, building up to RPE 9-10 on your last set.

F) Pull Conditioning (12-15 min):
2 Sets
For Time
500/400m Row @ 85% effort (male/female)
-60sec rest-
4 rounds for time:
10 Power Snatch (75/55#)

30 Double Unders or 60 Single Unders
-60-second rest and then repeat from the beginning for a second set-
Effort Note:
Perform the first set at a sustainable pace. The second set should be close to consistent speed as the first set.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday March 17, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Simple Solution
Simplicity in training can be so powerful. The less you are thinking about weights or reps or sets, the more you can think about pure muscle pump or mind to muscle connection. The simple pre fatigue format for today's training is an example of this. Keep it simple, but keep the pump big. Simple is strong!
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
DB Windmill Press; 5 reps/side
Banded Face Pull; 15-20 reps

C) Dip + Core + Shoulder Prefatigue (12 min):
3 Working Sets
Strict Bar or Ring Dip; 8-12 reps @30X0
directly into
Alternating Oblique Raise in Dip Support; 4-6 reps/side
rest 15sec
Single Arm DB Cuban Press; 10 reps/side
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:

Increase intensity each set. Start on the lower end of the reps (with less weight on the DB) and then increase weight and reps.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Strict Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Same weight as Set 3)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Flat Bench DB Fly; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
DB Full Raise; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Upper Body Conditioning (12 min):
12 min AMRAP @80-85% effort (As Many Rounds/Reps As Possible)
4-6-8-10...(add 2 reps each round)
Devils Press (50/35#) (male/female)
*8/6 Cal Bike between each set of Devils Press
Effort Note:
Pace both movements from the start. The first few rounds will feel easy, but the intensity will pick up quickly.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday March 18, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Back Squat Low Reps
Low reps are not inherently dangerous, but people often think they are. The beginning of a training block uses higher reps to get your body used to these particular movements. Then later in a training block, we can lower the reps and push the throttle more.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Cossack Squat; 8 reps/side
Lateral Banded Walk; 15 steps/side

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
+
Every 2:00 x 5 sets
2 Power Snatch
rest until the next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
4 Working Sets; rest 90-120 seconds between sets
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9+
Loading Note:
Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. The reps have decreased from Week 4, allowing for an increase in weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
B Stance Barbell Hip Thrust; 5 reps/side
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Single Leg Calf Raise; 10-12 reps/side @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

F) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15 sec
10/side DB Rack Curtsy Squat @ 20X0 50/35# or 35/20# (male/female)
20 GHD Sit Ups or 30 Feet Anchored Sit Up
rest 15 sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3-4 - Tough Pace

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday March 19, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 15 Sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
10 Split Stance DB RDL/side (lightweight)
10 Hanging Oblique Raises/side
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 15 Sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
Tall Kneeling Weight Plate Windmill x 6 reps/side (slow and controlled)
15m Quadruped Crawl Forward
15m Quadruped Crawl Backward

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Mobility
Shoulder Circles x 5 reps/side
Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min
Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Prayer Stretch x 2 min
Prone Y Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Shoulder Circles (or shoulder wall circles) x 5 reps/side
Passive Hang x 1 min

Friday March 20, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Reverse Barbell Curl
Building your biceps involves several muscles, not just one. The change in hand position of the Reverse Barbell Curl helps develop this muscle group in a slightly different way.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps

Ring Row Hold; 30 sec

C) Gymnastics HOT START (10-12 min):
5 Rounds for Time
1 Legless Rope Climb or 5 Strict Tuck Pull Up
12 Kipping Handstand Push Ups or 12 Yoga Push Ups
1 Rope Climb or 5 Strict Tuck Pull Up
12/10 Cal Bike
Effort Note:
Adjust pace as needed to prioritize high quality reps on the gymnastics movements.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Skullcrusher; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Reverse Barbell Curl; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from Week 1 and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

F) GRINDER Conditioning (12 min):
For Time @ Sustainable Pace
50m Dual KB Rack Carry 53/35# or 35/26#

8 Turkish Get Ups Right 53/35# or 35/26#
8 KB Windmill Right 53/35# or 35/26#
300/240m Row (male/female)
50m Dual KB Rack Carry 53/35# or 35/26#
300/240m Row
8 Turkish Get Ups Left 53/35# or 35/26#
8 KB Windmill Left 53/35# or 35/26#
50m Dual KB Rack Carry 53/35# or 35/26#
*Time Cap - 12mins
Effort Note:
These conditioning pieces are exploring challenging KB weights and movements like the GetUp and the Windmill over this 6-week cycle. Move at a controlled pace and slow down to make sure you execute the more complex movements correctly.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday March 21, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Long Sections of Training
The Strength Intensity and Conditioning sections are both longer than the 12-15 minute time domain that a lot of training sections fall under. These longer sections provide an opportunity to test your endurance and concentration. Just one extra set, one extra movement, or 5 more minutes of conditioning come with a lot of insights - take note.
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Step Through Reverse Lunge; 5 reps/side
Goblet Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15min):
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)

10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press
10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
+
5 sets; rest 90 sec between sets
2 Full Clean
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
DB Cyclist Front Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Drop Lunge; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Wall Sit; 45-60 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one set of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

E) Alphabet Soup (20-25 minutes):
4 Sets:
A. 12 DB Power Cleans 50/35# (male/female)
B. 12 Dumbbell Thrusters 50/35#
C. 300/275m Row
D. 10 DB Plank Rows (R + L = 1) 50/35#
E. 10 DB Suitcase Walking Lunge 50/35#
rest walk 2mins
Effort note:
Changing the exercise order each set requires good pacing and a better understanding of the demands of each individual movement. Follow this order:
Set 1 - ABCDE
Set 2 - EDCBA

Set 3 - CDEAB
Set 4 - BAEDC

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday March 22, 2026

Week 6 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM
Work In Lesson:

Big Ass Calendar

I bought a big ass calendar. It spans an entire wall. I did this out of a desire to look ahead, to wrap my mind around the entire foreseeable future.
It helps to take steps to control what we can. And the calendar is also dry-erase for a reason. Things change. Plans evaporate. Sudden curve balls come out of left field - when dang it, we were up at night worrying about different ones entirely.
So if something derails you from the track you were on with your fitness, that's okay. We all have injuries, family stuff, work stuff come up. The thing to pay attention to now is how you choose to react. The quicker you can erase the board and write something new in, the better. Because time will pass either way - don't waste it in the transitions.
With love,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday March 16, 2026

Week 6 Day 1 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Simple Solution

Simplicity in training can be so powerful. The less you are thinking about weights or reps or sets, the more you can think about pure muscle pump. The simple conditioning finisher format for today's training is an example of this. Keep it simple, but keep the pump big. Simple is strong!
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
DB Windmill Press; 5 reps/side
Bent Over Scap Retractions; 10 reps with 2 sec pause

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Push Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Same weight as Set 3)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 4-6 reps @31X2
rest 30sec
Flat Bench DB Fly; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 30sec
DB Full Raise; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
15-12-10-8-6
Alternating DB Glute Bridge Floor Press
DB Burpee
rest 30 sec between sets
Effort Note:

Select a weight that you can perform for multiple sets of 15 reps. Use the same weight for Floor Press and Burpees.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Tuesday March 17, 2026

Week 6 Day 2 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Strength Balance
Changing the order of movements can be a subtle way to keep getting stronger in different ways. So the lower body superset will sometimes change which type of movement you do first. For example, performing lunges before squats does not feel the same as performing lunges after squats. Which feels more comfortable for you?
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Single DB RDL; 6-8 reps/side
Supinated Body Row; 12-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. The reps have decreased slightly from Week 4 allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
DB Cyclist Front Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Drop Lunge; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Wall Sit; 45-60 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one pair of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15sec
8/side DB Rack Curtsy Squat @ 20X0 50/35# or 35/20# (male/female)
16 Hanging Leg Raise or Hanging Knee Tucks
rest 15sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3-4 - Tough Pace

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Wednesday March 18, 2026

Week 6 Day 3 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shinbox Special
Shinbox Switch x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Hip ER Stretch x 1 min
Shinbox Hip IR Stretch x 1 min
Shinbox Rear Leg ER x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Heel Touch x 5 reps/side

Thursday March 19, 2026

Week 6 Day 4 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Reverse DB Curl
Building your biceps involves several muscles, not just one. The change in hand position of the Reverse DB Curl helps develop this muscle group in a slightly different way.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Inchworm Push Up; 6-8 reps
Ring Row Hold; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 12 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 10 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 12 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets
DB Rolling Skullcrusher; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
DB Reverse Curl; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from Week 3 and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
6-10 Hand Release T Push Up
8-12 Dual DB Hang Snatch 50/35# (male/female) or 35/20#
5 Shuttle Run
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday March 20, 2026

Week 6 Day 5 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Squat Lower Reps
Low reps are not inherently dangerous, but people often think they are. The beginning of a training block uses higher reps to get your body used to these particular movements. Then later in a training block, we can lower the reps and push the throttle more.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Step Through Reverse Lunge; 5 reps/side
Goblet Goodmorning; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

1 1/4 Goblet Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. The reps have decreased from Week 4, allowing for an increase in weight.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
B Stance DB Hip Thrust; 5 reps/side
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Single Leg Calf Raise; 10-12 reps/side @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
10 DB Jump Squat
10 Left Leg Goblet Step Up 70/50# (male/female)
10 Right Leg Goblet Step Up 70/50#
20 Switch Lunge (10/side)
rest 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
The suggested loads are only here as a reference point. I want you to be able to move smoothly through all your weight reps without having to take breaks or slow down. If that means you need to lighten up your weight, then please do so.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday March 21, 2026

Week 6 Day 6 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 15 Sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
10 Split Stance DB RDL/side (lightweight)
10 Hanging Oblique Raises/side
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 15 Sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
Tall Kneeling Weight Plate Windmill x 6 reps/side (slow and controlled)
15m Quadruped Crawl Forward
15m Quadruped Crawl Backward

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Shoulder Extension
Passive Hang x 1 min
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 10 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10 reps

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Week 6 Day 7 - Persist MINIMALIST
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Marcus